

Love of Variety: July 2nd Update

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1 Overview

This document presents data facts and consumer patterns from the Nielsen HomeScan data I have been working on. I am currently working across all markets and focusing on single person households in an attempt to make shopping trends as clean as possible. Yogurt flavors are divided into three bins: plain, berry, and other. While these are broad, they appear to be relatively balanced in terms of how long people consume them and how often they switch. I also shrink down to 4-7 oz. cups of yogurt, again in an effort to get a clean baseline.

I find that, after a switch, 99% of households switch back, on average, to their original flavor. I also see households staying on switched-to flavors for about 2-3 periods before switching again. The data also shows 40% of households take the outside option in any given period (not buying yogurt). These facts are encouraging and suggest that, at least in yogurt cups, there is some preference for variety in consumption.

Below, I will list summary statistics with brief discussion and then follow that with some graphical evidence of switching behavior.

2 Summary Statistics

As stated above, all markets are present at this point, but households are subset to single person households. Further, to reiterate, flavor bins are plain, berry, and other.

1 Shows that about 42% of the time, on average, households are buying the same flavor. Further, a singular flavor only makes up 41% of consumption. However, brand is more constant, implying that households may buy the same flavor within brand rather than swapping along that dimension to the same degree.

The most popular flavor is plain, and sees the most average consecutive buys. This statistic warrants further investigation, as it is purchased 8 consecutive shopping trips while both berry and other are 4.2 consecutive trips. There are two possible explanations here. First, plain yogurt people are plain yogurt people and exhibit more state dependence. Second, there is a coding issue with flavor which I need to continue to look into. We do however, see that all flavors are similar in terms of how long they are switched to for, which is shown in ??.

Table 1: Descriptive Statistics

Statistic	Value
# Households	15440
Mean # Times Observed	15.76
Yogurt Purchases	1.85
Mean Income	\$16,277
Median Income	\$16,000
% White	81%
% Black	13%
% Hispanic	4%
% Asian	2%
% Taking Outside Option	0.41
Mean Repeat Purchase Rate (Brand)	75%
Mean Repeat Purchase Rate (Flavor)	42%
W/in HH Brand Concentration	55%
W/in HH Flavor Concentration	41%
Mean Consecutive Buys per HH (Other)	4.2
Mean Consecutive Buys per HH (Berry)	4.2
Mean Consecutive Buys per HH (Plain)	8.5
Mean % Return to Past Flavor After Switch	0.99

We do see that 99% of households return to their last flavor, behavior which is in line with what I had hoped to see from the households.

3 Figures

As stated above, the three bins are close in terms of length of being switched to. I also wanted to show the behavior when we make the flavor bins more granular, giving each major flavor its own bin. Here, we see plain dominates, highlighting the state dependence that plain yogurt people may have. This is exhibited in ?? and ??.

I am still playing with these bins, as I have to code them myself from flavor codes given by Nielsen.

4 Concluding and Next Steps

From here, I plan to continue to find the right way to define the data and recover more stats that could be used as micro-moments once I reach the estimation stage. I also hope to move to other product categories like cereal and ready to drink beverages. Any input is always appreciated.





